

EXCLUSIVE

IAS PRELIMS 2026

CURRENT AFFAIRS

REVISION

GS-1 (DYNAMIC)

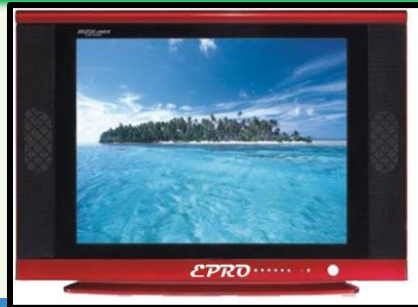
MODULE - 30



**POLITY & OTHER
NATIONAL
EVENTS - 5**



- Let us assume the Colour TV set is manufactured in Noida and the customer is in Palani, Tamil Nadu.
- There are several operations involved here – i.e., proper packaging, transportation to the Railway Station, loading in Delhi and unloading in Chennai. After that, it has to be loaded into the truck, then reach Palani and stored in the warehouse and then it will reach the customer. Whatever operations involved in this entire process, all put together constitute logistics costs.
- As far as India is concerned, logistics costs are very high in comparison to developed countries.
- The reasons are - lack of proper multi-modal connectivity, informal processes involved in various operations, lack of proper integration of operations, lack of last mile connectivity, among others.





- Logistics costs in India are at around 14% of GDP. Now, Government plans to reduce the logistics costs to less than 10% of GDP.
- There are three pillars of the Government planning:
 - ✓ National Infrastructure Pipeline - massive infrastructure rollout.
 - ✓ PM Gati Shakti - whatever projects undertaken by various departments, they will be mapped onto one platform.
 - ✓ National Logistics Policy - the firms associated with logistics will be brought under one single platform.



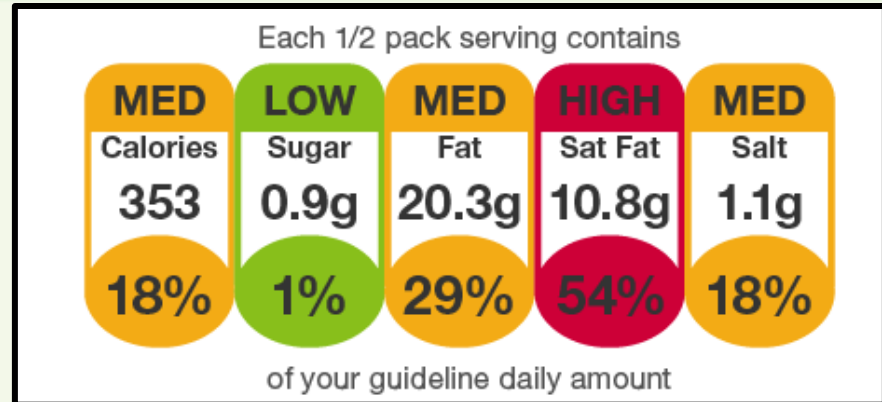


- In general, under the World Trade Organization (WTO) Framework, the tariffs should be uniform for all the countries. Free Trade Agreements reduce the tariffs among those FTA partners. Due to that, Free Trade Agreements are gaining ground day by day.
- When Free Trade Agreement is signed between two countries, the relations between these two countries are also expected to increase in the long run and may lead to strategic partnerships.
- It may also facilitate becoming part of the regional supply chains.
- Moreover, the World Trade Organization (WTO) is becoming less effective day by day, so the countries are looking at Free Trade Agreements.

What do you understand by Front-of-Pack Labelling? Is the Front-of-Pack Labelling mandatory in India?



- On September 20, 2022, the FSSAI came out with Front-of-Pack Labelling (FoPL) draft regulation and subsequently invited public comments. However, FoPL is yet to be implemented.
- National Human Rights Commission (NHRC) has expressed profound concern and sought a response from the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) about the front-of-pack food labels that should provide consumers with information to make healthier choices.

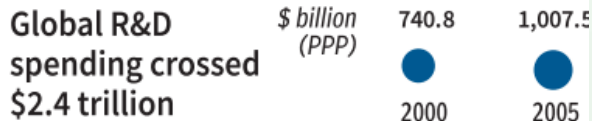
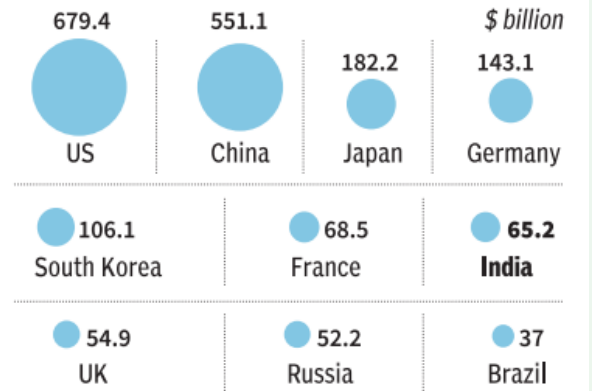


What are the differences in R&D expenditure of India and Western Countries?

INDIA'S R&D EXPENDITURE IS JUST \$65 BILLION!

India's R&D spend 7th highest globally

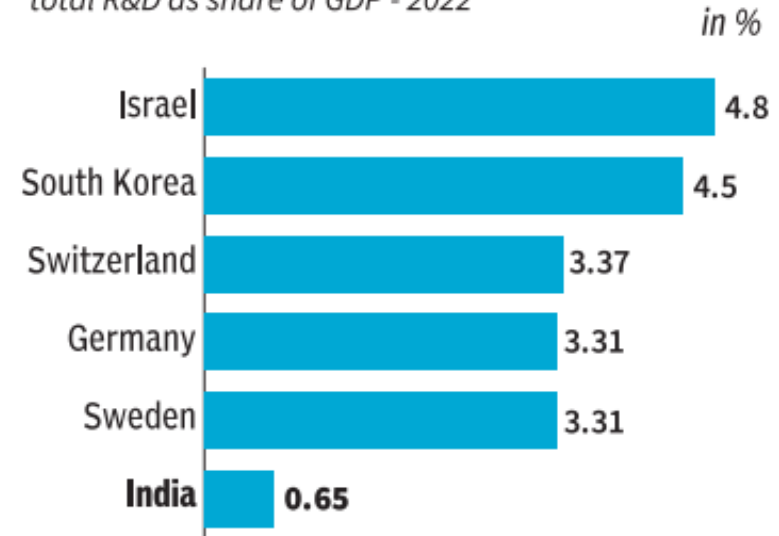
Top countries with highest total R&D expenditure - 2022



R&D SPEND IS JUST 0.65% OF GDP IN INDIA!

But spend as a share of GDP is very low

Top 5 countries with highest total R&D as share of GDP - 2022





- In 2020-21, the Private Sector Industry contributed 36.4% of the GERD, with the Centre (43.7%), State Governments (6.7%), higher education (8.8%), and public sector industry (4.4%) accounting for the rest.
- Though India's expenditure on R&D has been increasing in absolute terms, from more than Rs. 1.1 lakh crore in 2009-10 to Rs. 1.27 lakh crore in 2020-21, but as a fraction of GDP, it has been declining steadily in the same period, from an already sub-par 0.82% to around 0.64%.

In the more technologically advanced countries, GERD accounts for at least 1% of GDP. Even Brazil (1.16%) and South Africa (0.83%) have a higher GERD-to-GDP ratio.



NITI Aayog



As per Niti Aayog, as many as 24.82 crore people moved out of multi-dimensional poverty in nine years to 2022-23 with Uttar Pradesh, Bihar and Madhya Pradesh registering the largest decline. Multi-dimensional Poverty in India declined from 29.17% in 2013-14 to 11.28% in 2022-23.

- It measures simultaneous deprivations across three equally weighted dimensions of health, education and standard of living that are represented by 12 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) aligned indicators.
- These include
 - ✓ Nutrition
 - ✓ Child and adolescent mortality
 - ✓ Maternal health
 - ✓ Years of schooling
 - ✓ School attendance
 - ✓ Cooking fuel
 - ✓ Sanitation
 - ✓ Drinking water
 - ✓ Electricity
 - ✓ Housing
 - ✓ Assets
 - ✓ Bank accounts
- The National Multi-Dimensional Poverty Index by Niti Aayog uses the Alkire-Foster (AF) methodology to assess the decline in poverty rates.

However, the national MPI covers 12 indicators, while global MPI covers 10 indicators.



- It is used in healthcare and in green industries.
- Its industrial applications exploit the metal's high conductivity (which is the highest for any element in both electricity and heat).
- It also has properties like sensitivity to light and antibacterial qualities. It is a raw material in solder and in welding and bracing alloys.
- It is also used as raw material in batteries and in dentistry.
- It has increasing demand due to being used in medicines, solar energy, radio frequency identification chips, semiconductors, cell phone touch screens and water purification systems, among others.

Less than 15% of gold is used for industrial and scientific applications whereas, more than half of annual silver consumption is driven by industrial uses.



- China does not recognise the sovereignty of Arunachal Pradesh with India.
- In 1913, Tibet declared Independence and China did not recognise the independence declared by Tibet and in subsequent year 1914, British India and Tibet had an agreement, which was the basis for McMahon Line, or the boundary between India and China.
- China does not recognise McMahon Line and it feels Arunachal Pradesh area of about 90,000 sq. km. is part of its Tibet region and it calls it South Tibet or Zangnan.



What are the primary crops grown in the Kharif season in India? How do you compare one with the other?



Final kharif acreage (in lakh hectares)

	Normal Area	2023	2022	% Change
Paddy	399.45	411.96	404.27	1.9
Pulses	139.7	123.57	128.98	-4.2
Arhar	46.29	43.87	46.13	-4.9
Uradbean	39.23	33.08	33.52	-1.3
Moongbean	36.55	31.94	33.99	-6.05
Kulthi	2	0.48	0.53	-10.61
Other pulses	15.63	14.21	14.81	-4.08
Coarse cereals	181.91	188.02	184.77	1.76
Jowar	17.36	14.53	15.88	-8.48
Bajra	73.24	70.95	70.59	0.5
Ragi	10.94	11	10.64	3.41
Small millets	4.66	5.76	5.05	13.96
Maize	75.71	85.79	82.62	3.84
Oilseeds	189.81	193.23	196.39	-1.61
Groundnut	45.04	43.91	45.53	-3.55
Soyabean	117.44	125.62	124.79	0.66
Sunflower	1.23	0.73	2.04	-64.23
Sesamum	15.94	12.43	13.44	-7.48
Niger	1.48	0.91	1.13	-20.23
Castor	8.68	9.52	9.31	2.25
Other Oilseeds	0	0.11	0.14	-23.16
Sugarcane	48.85	59.91	55.66	7.64
Jute & Mesta	6.88	6.59	6.98	-5.57



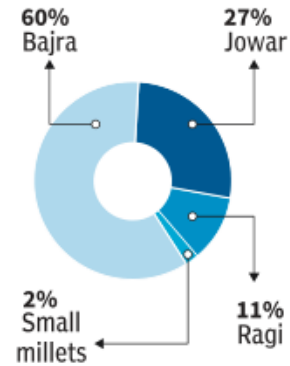
Sowing of Rabi crops (in lakh hectare)

	2023-24	2022-23	% change (year-ago)
Wheat	308.67	314.42	-1.8
Rice	12.67	14.04	-9.8
Pulses	137.13	148.53	-7.7
Gram	94.03	103.35	-9.0
Lentil	17.97	17.77	1.1
Coarse cereals	46.01	44.83	2.6
Jowar	20.62	20.71	-0.4
Maize	16.73	15.82	5.8
Barley	8.01	7.71	3.9
Oilseeds	102.38	102.21	0.2
Rapeseed & mustard	95.23	93.46	1.9
Groundnut	3.12	3.98	-21.6
Total Crops	606.86	624.03	-2.8

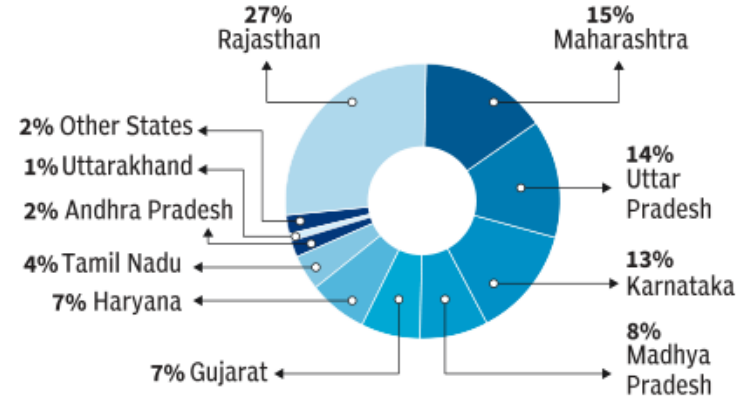


Millet production*

Crop-wise



State-wise





THESE TWO ARE NOT MILLETS

MAIZE



BARLEY



BOTH IN KHARIF/RABI

EXCLUSIVE RABI

- All the coarse cereals are **not millets**.
- **Maize** is the largest grown coarse cereal in the country. In India, **majority** of the **Maize** was used as a **poultry feed**. In recent years, more and more maize is being diverted for ethanol production.

THESE THREE ARE MILLETS

BAJRA



EXCLUSIVE KHARIF

RAGI



EXCLUSIVE KHARIF

JOWAR
(SORGHUM)

BOTH IN KHARIF/RABI

- These millets are **part of the coarse cereals**.
- **Bajra** (Pearl Millet) is the largest grown millet in the country.

**TWO EXCLUSIVE KHARIF**

BAJRA
(PEARL
MILLETS)



RAGI
(FINGER MILLETS)

**ONE KHARIF/RABI**

JOWAR
(SORGHUM)



- Millets originated through the domestication of wild African grasses in the Nile Valley and the Sahel Zone in Africa.
- India is the largest producer of Millets in the World.
- In India, millets are grown both in kharif and rabi seasons.
- Production is almost stagnant during the previous decade.



- Across the World, India, Bangladesh and Pakistan account for more than 90% of the ship breaking yards.
- Majority of the working plots in Alang are certified for green recycling standards.
- These are prescribed by the Hong Kong International Convention for the safe and environmentally sound recycling of ships.
- It was adopted by the International Maritime Organization in 2009.



- India is home to 18% of the world's population and only 4% of the global water resources.
- Annual availability is approximately 1,123 Billion Cubic Meters (BCM). Surface water accounts for the majority comprising 690 BCM while groundwater contributes 433 BCM to the total water supply.
- Agriculture is the largest consumer utilizing about 78% of India's total water resources. The domestic sector consumes 6% while industry utilizes 5%.
- India uses an estimated 230 cubic kilometers of groundwater per year, over 1/4th of the global total. More than 60% of irrigated agriculture and 85% of drinking water supplies are dependent on groundwater.

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